12.4 Tonsillectomy (Adult)*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "It hurts a lot to swallow." • Rates pain 7/10 **Objective** • Sore throat • Reluctant to eat	**ACTUAL** Acute pain related to surgical trauma of the pharynx as evidenced by pain on swallowing.	• Pain controlled enough for eating and drinking.	• Give regular analgesia, timed before meals. • Offer cool drinks and soft food. • Encourage a return to a normal diet, which helps healing.	• Goal reached when he is eating and drinking.
Subjective • "I am not drinking much because of pain." **Objective** • Low fluid intake • Dry mouth	**ACTUAL** Inadequate fluid volume related to pain-limited intake as evidenced by dry mucosa.	• Drinking at least 1.5 L a day within 24 hours.	• Chart fluid intake. • Offer drinks often. • Start IV fluids if ordered.	• Met with adequate intake.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Tonsillar bed	**RISK** Risk for excessive bleeding as evidenced by risk factors: surgical wound in a vascular area.	• No post-operative bleeding.	• Watch for frequent swallowing, fresh blood and a rising heart rate. • Tell him to report any bleeding after discharge, especially on days 5–10.	• Achieved if no bleeding occurs.

* **References for this care plan:** [14], [32], [35], [37]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.